Section II

Reading

On the day of his travel, Vetri **boarded** the train, his memory went back to his schooldays. They lived in the beautiful village Keelakudi, near Coimbatore. Vetri and Asif studied in a middle school which was in the outskirts of the village. The students and teachers of the school would never forget Vetri and Asif and their friendship. They were always together learning and playing.

Their friendship started on the first day of school. When Vetri's parents dropped him at the school, he started crying. Asif **consoled** him with a chocolate and said, "Don't cry, let's play together." After that day, they stayed together, played together and even **exchanged** their food. Their friendship grew stronger over time. They were always good in studies and helped each other in studies. They also helped the others with their lessons.

One day there was a quarrel between Vetri and Asif's families, and both families stopped talking to each other. To everyone's surprise they continued to be good friends. There was always a healthy **competition** between them. Surprisingly the exams or the results or the marks never **affected** their friendship. Their friendship continued till tenth standard. Then Vetri moved to Coimbatore and Asif to Chennai. Asif started his business in Chennai and settled there. Vetri always wanted to meet his friend but never had the chance to visit Chennai.

Glossary

boarded	-	get on or into a vehicle
consoled	-	comfort someone at the time of grief
exchanged	-	give something and receive something
competition	-	an event or contest
affected	-	cause a change in someone or something

Say True or False.

1. Vetri lived in Keelakudi.
2. There was a middle school in the middle of the village Keelakudi.
3. Vetri and Asif were not so good in studies.
4. Vetri never visited Chennai.
5. Asif was a businessman.

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